



The Impact of Job Satisfaction on the Professional Performance of Nurses in Palestine

أثر الرضا الوظيفي على الأداء المهني لدى الممرضين في فلسطين

BY

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Abstract:

This study aimed to assess the level of job satisfaction among nurses working in governmental hospitals in Palestine, identify key factors influencing their satisfaction, and examine the impact of these factors on professional nursing performance. A cross-sectional, descriptive, analytical design was used, involving 293 nurses from Emergency Departments (EDs) "180" and Intensive Care Units (ICUs) "113". Data were collected using a self-administered questionnaire measuring job satisfaction and professional performance. Findings revealed that most participating nurses were young males with limited experience and low income, which may affect their job stability and satisfaction. Overall job satisfaction was moderate, with high satisfaction in co-worker relationships and low satisfaction in promotion opportunities and working conditions. In contrast, professional performance levels were high, particularly in quality and creativity. A strong positive correlation was found between job satisfaction and professional performance ($r = 0.728$, $p = 0.001$), and regression analysis indicated that job satisfaction explained 64.2% of the variance in performance. Socio-demographic factors showed no significant effect, highlighting the greater influence of organizational conditions. The study concludes that enhancing managerial support, improving financial incentives, and expanding opportunities for professional development are essential for boosting job satisfaction, sustaining high performance, and strengthening workforce stability within Palestine's governmental healthcare sector.

Keywords: Job Satisfaction; Professional Performance; Nurses, Emergency Departments; Intensive Care Units.

المستخلص:

هدفت هذه الدراسة إلى تقييم مستوى الرضا الوظيفي لدى الممرضين العاملين في المستشفيات الحكومية في فلسطين، وتحديد العوامل الرئيسة المؤثرة في رضاهم، وفحص أثر هذه العوامل على الأداء المهني التمريضي. استخدمت الدراسة تصميمًا مقطعيًا وصفيًا تحليليًا، وشملت ٢٩٣ ممرضاً من أقسام الطوارئ (١٨٠) والعناية المركزة (١١٣). جُمعت البيانات باستخدام استبانة ذاتية لقياس الرضا الوظيفي والأداء المهني. أظهرت النتائج أن غالبية المشاركين كانوا ممرضين شباباً من الذكور، يمتلكون خبرة محدودة ودخلاً منخفضاً، وهي عوامل قد تؤثر سلباً على الاستقرار الوظيفي والرضا. بلغ مستوى الرضا الوظيفي العام درجة متوسطة، مع أعلى رضا في علاقات الزملاء، وأدنى رضا في فرص الترقّي وظروف العمل. في المقابل، كان مستوى الأداء المهني مرتفعاً، خصوصاً في مجالات الجودة والإبداع. كشفت النتائج وجود علاقة ارتباط إيجابية قوية بين الرضا الوظيفي والأداء المهني ($r = 0.728, p = 0.001$)، كما أوضح تحليل الانحدار أن الرضا الوظيفي يفسر ٦٤.٢% من تباين الأداء. ولم تُظهر الخصائص الديموغرافية أثراً معنوياً، مما يبرز التأثير الأكبر للعوامل التنظيمية. وتختتم الدراسة بالتأكيد على ضرورة تعزيز الدعم الإداري، وتحسين الحوافز المالية، وتوسيع فرص التطوير المهني لرفع مستوى الرضا والحفاظ على أداء مهني مرتفع داخل القطاع الصحي الحكومي الفلسطيني.

الكلمات المفتاحية: الرضا الوظيفي؛ الأداء المهني؛ الممرضون، أقسام الطوارئ؛ وحدة العناية المركزة.

Introduction

Worldwide healthcare systems are increasingly challenged by limited resources, rising demand, and rapid technological innovations, all of which have transformed both the meaning and delivery of quality nursing care (Almashayekh et al., 2023). Nursing is one of the noblest professions, requiring not only competence and technical expertise but also compassion and a genuine commitment to patient care that lead to substantial burdens on nurses—the largest segment of the healthcare workforce—who must collaborate with multidisciplinary teams and address patients' multifaceted needs (Cummings et al., 2018). Nurses provide approximately 80% of direct patient care and maintain close contact with

patients, making it essential to ensure their job satisfaction (Isfahani et al., 2024).

Job satisfaction in the nursing field directly impacts the quality of patient care, making it a widely discussed and highly valued topic. Job satisfaction is defined as “a pleasant or positive emotional state resulting from the evaluation of one’s own work or the experiences associated with work” (Kalinowska & Marcinowicz, 2020). It produces positive outcomes for both nurses and patients; for nurses, these benefits include reduced job stress, lower turnover rates, and decreased risk of burnout (Wali et al., 2023).

As work demands rise, nurses must manage heavier workloads while maintaining the highest standards of patient care. High-paced environments, rotating shifts, and continuous responsibilities place nurses at an elevated risk of job dissatisfaction. This dissatisfaction not only affects nurses’ well-being but also influences their performance and the quality of care they provide as frontline healthcare workers (Jiang et al., 2016).

Although job satisfaction has been extensively studied in hospital settings, research under epidemic or crisis conditions need more research (Tarcn et al., 2017). Meta-analyses indicate a strong negative correlation between job stress and job satisfaction (Zangaro & Soeken, 2007). Nurses and physicians report higher stress and lower satisfaction than administrative staff, particularly in governmental hospitals (Suárez et al., 2017). Moreover, stress has been shown to negatively affect nurse performance, as demonstrated in studies at King Abdullah Hospital in Jordan (Al-khasawneh & Moh, 2013).

Job satisfaction is strongly influenced by work-related stress, which can diminish emotional well-being and engagement. During infectious disease outbreaks, nurses face intensified fear, anxiety, and compassion fatigue (Ahorsu et al.,

2020; Alharbi et al., 2020), potentially leading to post-traumatic stress and reduced effectiveness at work (Kameg, 2020). Studies consistently show higher rates of anxiety and depression among nurses compared to other healthcare professionals and the general population (Pappa et al., 2020).

Nurse performance refers to the effectiveness with which nurses execute their duties and responsibilities in patient care (Maridi et al., 2023). It is a critical area of study given that nurses constitute the largest hospital workforce (Hasanah & Maharani, 2022) and provide continuous, direct patient care around the clock (Agustin et al., 2022). Nurses play a pivotal role in healthcare delivery and significantly influence the quality, efficiency, and public perception of health services.

Given the importance of nurses in maintaining healthcare quality and their close interaction with patients, ensuring job satisfaction is essential not only for their well-being but also for optimal patient outcomes. Therefore, this study seeks to assess the level of job satisfaction among nurses and examine its impact on their professional performance within governmental hospitals in Palestine, employing linear regression analysis to identify the relationship between these key variables and provide evidence-based recommendations for enhancing both nurse satisfaction and performance.

Research Problem:

Nurses play a central role in healthcare delivery, particularly in critical areas such as emergency and intensive care units, where they provide approximately 80% of direct patient care. Despite their essential role, nurses in these departments face numerous challenges that can negatively affect their job satisfaction and professional performance. The high-paced and emotionally demanding nature of emergency department and intensive care nursing exposes nurses to constant stress, long working hours, rotating shifts, and

psychological strain from patient suffering. This environment not only affects nurses' well-being but also has direct implications for the quality of patient care and overall healthcare efficiency.

Previous research has consistently highlighted the critical link between job satisfaction and professional performance. For example, Setiawan and Meilani (2022) found that hospital employees' job satisfaction had a positive and significant effect on performance. Similarly, Chen et al. (2020) reported that high job satisfaction among doctors was associated with high hospital performance. Kousar et al. (2018) concluded that nurse job satisfaction enhances performance and contributes to the development of the health service system. However, despite these findings, research in the health sector often reports low to moderate levels of job satisfaction among healthcare workers (Maridi et al., 2023; Wali et al., 2023).

In the context of Palestinian governmental hospitals, these challenges are intensified by systemic limitations, including poor infrastructure, managerial issues, and inadequate staff support. While studies in other countries have explored factors affecting nurse satisfaction and performance, there is limited research in Palestine examining the direct relationship between job satisfaction and professional performance among nurses in emergency and intensive care units.

Therefore, it is essential to investigate the level of job satisfaction among nurses and its impact on their professional performance in these critical departments. Understanding these dynamics will provide evidence-based insights to guide policy, improve working conditions, enhance nurse well-being, and ultimately elevate the quality of patient care in Palestinian hospitals.

General Objectives:

This study aims to evaluate job satisfaction among ER and ICU nurses in governmental hospitals in Palestine, explore the key factors that undermine it, and examine how these factors influence nurses' professional performance.

Specific Objectives:

- To assess a level of job satisfaction of Palestinians nurses working at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine.
- To determinate Performance level of Palestinians nurses working at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine.
- To assess the correlation between job satisfaction and socio-demographic variables (age, marital and family status, residence place, income, and education level).
- To determine the relationship between the level of job satisfaction and its effect on nursing performance.

Research questions:

- What is the level of job satisfaction of Palestinians nurses working at at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine?
- What is the level of Performance of Palestinians nursing working at at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine?
- Is there a correlation between socio-demographic variables and job satisfaction of Palestinians nursing working at at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine?
- Is there a correlation between socio-demographic variables and burnout of Palestinians nursing working at ER and ICU at southern governorates of Palestine?
- Does job satisfaction effect on the performance of Palestinians ER and ICU nursing?

Definition of Terms

This part will contain the definition of terms included in this study

Job satisfaction

It is a group of emotional feelings that the individual feels towards the work, which he is currently occupying, and these feelings may be negative or positive, and they express the extent of satisfaction that the individual imagines that he achieves from his work. This work is positive, that is, the more he is satisfied with his work, but the more the individual imagines that his work deprives him of this satisfaction, the more his feelings towards this work are negative, i.e., the more he is dissatisfied with his work in (Ángel et al., 2014).

Professional Performance

Professional performance is a multidimensional construct which indicates how well employees perform their tasks, the initiative they take and the resourcefulness they show in solving problems. Professional performance is affected by many situational factors such as environmental characteristics, entrepreneurship dimensions, organization itself, coworkers, and internal factors. Internal factors refer to which factors such as personality traits, needs, attitudes, preferences, motivations, entrepreneurship dimensions, and beliefs that motivate them to react to situational factors. Moreover, job performance could be affected by other factors such as need to achievement, span of control, self-confidence, capacity, and interaction between these factors (Allameh, Sadr and Ghafari, 2012).

Literature Review

Job Satisfaction:

Organizations strive to ensure employee job satisfaction because satisfied staff play a crucial role in achieving organizational goals and sustaining productivity. In this context,

understanding nurses' job satisfaction becomes particularly important during periods of pandemics, excessive workloads, occupational stress, and nurse shortages caused by high turnover rates. Job satisfaction has been identified as a key factor—and a strategic priority—in efforts to retain nursing staff (Aminuddin et al., 2023).

Evidence shows that job satisfaction positively influences nurses' perceptions of the quality of care they provide. Several scholars have indicated that higher job satisfaction leads to improved outcomes and has therefore become a central focus in studies related to nursing processes and healthcare quality. Reported outcomes of enhanced nurse job satisfaction include improved quality of healthcare services, reduced turnover, and decreased burnout (Krepia et al., 2023). Furthermore, maintaining high levels of job satisfaction among nurses directly contributes to lowering infection rates and reducing morbidity within the nursing workforce, particularly during high-risk situations such as epidemics and crises (Savitsky et al., 2023)

The concept of job satisfaction:

The term job satisfaction is a relatively recent term that appeared in the twentieth century, and this term refers to a variety of factors that can affect an individual's feeling about his job, and these factors include wages and benefits, the fairness of the promotion system within the institution or organization, leadership and supervision, and social relations. Which may contribute positively or negatively to the individual's motivation to accomplish the tasks required of him.

Brayer & Marcinowicz (2018) defined job satisfaction as employees' different attitudes about their jobs and their awareness of the things they desire, as it is a combination of environmental and psychological factors that affect productivity, loyalty and belonging that leading to the achievement of the desired goals pursued to the organization.

Job satisfaction is defined as the general attitude towards work or job, which expresses the difference between what an individual gets through the performance of his duties and his expectations resulting from his performance of the same jobs (Anitha, 2011), Job satisfaction also expresses the employee's feeling about the role he plays in the institution or organization in which he works, which is reflected in his other roles outside the work environment as a member of the community in which he interacts with others (Naveed et al, 2016).

Others believe that job satisfaction is the product of the interaction of a group of psychological, physiological and environmental conditions that affect an individual's feeling about his job, and although satisfaction is under the influence of many external factors, there are internal factors that cannot be overlooked, which is the way the employee feels. Which determines his level of satisfaction or dissatisfaction (Molla, 2015).

Job satisfaction can also be defined as the individual's feeling of happiness and satisfaction as a result of satisfying his needs and desires and achieving his expectations through the work he performs, which leads to an increase in his confidence, loyalty, and belonging to the institution or organization in which he works (Al-Saidi, 2013).

The importance of job satisfaction:

Nurses particularly those working in ED and ICU are exposed to some of the highest levels of physical, psychological, and social stress within the healthcare system. These units deal with acute, life-threatening conditions and receive a continuously rising number of critical patients, which intensifies workload pressures and increases vulnerability to burnout, dissatisfaction, and performance decline.

Understanding job satisfaction in these settings is therefore essential, as it directly affects not only nurses' well-being but also the quality and safety of patient care. Research shows that despite the extreme challenges faced by ED and ICU nurses, many demonstrate strong resilience grounded in personal values, optimism, spirituality, professional skills, and supportive work environments (Giménez-Espert et al., 2020; Benadé et al., 2017). This resilience highlights the critical need to examine the factors that enhance or undermine job satisfaction so that healthcare systems can better support frontline staff.

Given the shortage of nurses, increased patient load, limited resources, and inadequate compensation in governmental hospitals—especially during crises and epidemics—investigating job satisfaction among ED and ICU nurses becomes even more crucial. Ensuring their satisfaction is not only a workforce management priority but also a key determinant of care quality, patient outcomes, and organizational stability.

Factors that Contribute to Job Satisfaction

A variety of approaches have been developed to examine job satisfaction, leading to extensive research that has identified numerous determinants influencing employees' attitudes toward their work (Unutmaz, 2014). These determinants provide essential insights into how workplace conditions shape satisfaction levels and overall organizational effectiveness.

Several key factors consistently contribute to job satisfaction across professional settings. These include the quality of supervision, opportunities for promotion, rewards and compensation systems, relationships with coworkers, the nature of the job itself, work conditions, recognition, and organizational policies and management practices (Asare, 2019). Such factors collectively shape employees' motivation, engagement, and commitment to their roles.

Saari et al. (2004) classify the determinants of job satisfaction into two major categories: intrinsic factors and extrinsic factors. Intrinsic factors—such as supervision quality, coworker relationships, and the characteristics of the job itself—relate to the internal experiences derived from work. In contrast, extrinsic factors include elements external to the task, such as financial compensation, benefits, and opportunities for advancement.

This classification aligns with classic motivational theories, especially those proposed by Frederick Herzberg and Abraham Maslow. Herzberg et al. (1959) identified extrinsic elements like supervision as hygiene factors in his two-factor motivation theory, meaning that while they may not generate high satisfaction on their own, their absence can lead to dissatisfaction. Intrinsic factors, on the other hand, act as motivators that enhance job satisfaction and foster higher levels of performance

Supervision and communication:

Supervision relies heavily on communication and feedback, which are essential for employee satisfaction and productivity. Effective interaction between supervisors and subordinates allows nurses to perform better and increases their engagement (Asare, 2019). Conversely, poor communication and lack of feedback are associated with lower job satisfaction (Kim, 2012).

Empirical studies confirm that feedback and emotional support from supervisors positively influence nurses' job satisfaction and performance. Rasheed et al. (2015) found that constructive feedback in government health institutions directly enhanced satisfaction and productivity. Similarly, leadership support and positive supervisory practices improve nurses' engagement, reduce burnout, and foster professional growth (Pohl & Galletta, 2017; Hunt, 2014; Shahdadi et al., 2016;

Masum et al., 2016; Maulabakhsh & Raziq, 2015). Effective supervisors also contribute to conflict management, talent development, and overall team performance.

Salary and rewards:

One of the main factors that attracts and retains employees in any organization is the compensation package. Compensation includes various elements such as salaries, wages, pay grades, bonuses, and workforce budgeting (McNamara, 2016). In healthcare settings, nurses are often remunerated through base pay or variable compensation programs for completing tasks. Common forms of compensation include salaries, wages, bonuses, and tips (Baker, 2016).

Tips are typically provided by managers or clients as recognition for high-quality service. Variable pay may also depend on nurses' experience and performance, while bonuses serve as additional incentives to reward outstanding contributions. Effective compensation strategies enhance employee motivation, engagement, and job satisfaction, which in turn positively impact performance and the quality of patient care (McNamara, 2016).

Coworkers:

Coworkers, or colleagues, play a significant role in influencing job satisfaction. They are members of a team working together to achieve organizational goals, and being part of a supportive and effective team enhances employees' satisfaction (Asare, 2019). So positive interactions and socialization among coworkers not only improve happiness at work but also increase productivity.

A workplace where employees respect, support, and share ideas with one another fosters productivity, well-being, and effective teamwork. During crises such as pandemics, peer support can improve psychological safety, alleviate fear, and

boost morale, enabling nurses to perform effectively under challenging conditions (Maben & Bridges, 2020).

Working conditions:

Working conditions encompass the physical and emotional environment of the workplace and are crucial in shaping employees' satisfaction and performance. A positive work environment—characterized by safety, good communication, supportive supervision, and respect for employee rights—enhances commitment and productivity (Akinwale, 2019). When employees feel valued, their dedication and sense of ownership increase (Adegoke et al., 2015). Key elements such as fair wages, reasonable working hours, autonomy, and clear organizational structure also contribute to higher satisfaction (Lane et al., 2010).

Conversely, unfavorable conditions—such as heavy workload, inadequate staffing, long shifts, and noisy settings—have been linked to lower job satisfaction among healthcare workers (Yasin et al., 2020).

Promotions:

Promotion refers to an employee's upward movement to a higher position with greater responsibilities and improved pay (Heathfield, 2015). Workplace promotions may take several forms: up-or-out promotion (seeking promotion outside the organization), dry promotion (a higher title without salary increase), and paper promotion (promotion with higher salary in another department within the same organization) (Burks, 2015).

Studies show that promotion opportunities significantly enhance nurses' job satisfaction; more than half of surveyed nurses reported higher satisfaction when promotion prospects were available (Emadi et al., 2015). Professional development also plays a crucial role in increasing promotion chances, enabling employees to acquire advanced skills needed to handle complex tasks (Savitsky et al., 2023). Conversely, limited

growth and development opportunities are major sources of dissatisfaction among nurses.

Job satisfaction characteristics

Job satisfaction is essentially a subjective concept connected to employees' internal feelings and perceptions about their work. Although it originates within the individual, it can be reflected through observable behaviors that indicate the employee's level of comfort or discomfort in the workplace (Azyoun, 2007). It is also considered a relative issue, as it is influenced by job conditions, personal ambitions, and the employee's ability to adapt to the work environment.

Furthermore, job satisfaction is dynamic in nature. An employee who is satisfied with certain working conditions—such as wages or benefits—today may not feel the same level of satisfaction in the future. This highlights the importance of continuously developing work conditions to keep pace with changes in employees' needs and living standards (Al-Anazi, 2016).

Due to the complexity of the factors influencing it, job satisfaction is difficult for organizations to fully control. Therefore, institutions must try to identify all relevant factors and address elements that may reduce employee satisfaction. Job satisfaction is closely linked to the organizational and social context of work, and it is typically examined at the individual level because employees differ widely in their expectations, goals, and personal values.

Finally, job satisfaction can take different forms. It may be related to specific aspects of a job—known as partial or qualitative satisfaction—or it may encompass all aspects of the work environment, representing overall or general job satisfaction (Chas et al., 2016).

Manifestations of job satisfaction

Job satisfaction is not directly observable; rather, it is expressed through certain manifestations that reveal its presence in employees. The key manifestations is:

Performance level:

Performance reflects the degree of achievement and completion of the tasks that make up an individual's job and indicates how effectively the individual meets job requirements (Baseri, 2013). Research on the relationship between job satisfaction and performance has identified three perspectives: the first considers the satisfied employee as the highest performing, suggesting that job satisfaction is a productive factor; the second sees no direct relationship between satisfaction and performance, proposing that productivity can be increased through external pressure; and the third views job satisfaction as a result of improved performance, where employees feel satisfied when they receive elements such as remuneration, promotion, appreciation, job security, and fair leadership (Al-Dakhil, 2017).

According to Karem et al. (2019) job satisfaction play a crucial role in enhancing nurse performance. Hospitals can improve performance by offering competitive salaries, effective promotion opportunities, and favorable working conditions. Nurses who are satisfied with their jobs demonstrate higher levels of dedication, efficiency, and effectiveness, which directly contributes to the quality of patient care. Given that nurses constitute a major component of the hospital workforce, their job satisfaction is vital to overall hospital performance and service delivery.

Organizational loyalty:

Organizational loyalty reflects the depth of employees' emotional attachment, commitment, and sense of responsibility

towards their organization. It indicates the willingness of employees to remain in the organization, contribute actively to its objectives, and endure challenges without complaint. Research indicates that organizational loyalty is strongly influenced by job satisfaction, as employees who are satisfied with their roles tend to cooperate more effectively, build stronger interpersonal relationships with colleagues, and exhibit greater dedication to organizational goals (Tnay et al., 2013).

In the healthcare sector, particularly in high-stress environments such as ED and ICU, organizational loyalty among nurses becomes even more critical. Nurses facing heavy workloads, emotional stress, and life-or-death situations must rely on teamwork, institutional support, and mutual trust. High job satisfaction enhances nurses' loyalty, encouraging them to remain in their positions, engage proactively in patient care, and contribute to the smooth functioning of the healthcare team (Krepia et al., 2023).

Moreover, satisfied nurses demonstrate stronger resilience and commitment, which helps reduce turnover rates, absenteeism, and burnout. This continuity of experienced staff ensures higher quality of care, better patient outcomes, and increased operational efficiency within hospitals. Organizational loyalty also supports a positive workplace culture, where nurses feel valued, recognized, and motivated to maintain high standards of professionalism (Almashayekh et al., 2023).

In essence, job satisfaction and organizational loyalty are interlinked; one reinforces the other. By investing in strategies that improve nurses' satisfaction—such as fair compensation, recognition, supportive supervision, opportunities for professional growth, and a healthy work environment—hospitals can cultivate a loyal, motivated, and high-performing nursing workforce, which directly impacts the quality and safety of patient care.

Low absenteeism rate:

Absenteeism is widely recognized as a sensitive behavioral indicator of employees' psychological state, morale, and overall job satisfaction. When employees experience dissatisfaction—whether due to poor working conditions, lack of recognition, weak leadership, or job stress—they are more likely to avoid the workplace, resulting in a higher absenteeism rate. This makes absenteeism not merely an administrative or logistical issue, but a reflection of underlying organizational problems (Isfahani et al., 2024).

In contrast, employees who feel satisfied and valued in their roles tend to exhibit a strong presence at work. When the level of satisfaction derived from being at the workplace exceeds any perceived benefit from being absent, attendance becomes a natural and consistent behavior. Such employees feel connected to their organizational environment, supported by positive relationships, fair policies, and meaningful tasks. As a result, they demonstrate higher commitment, responsibility, and readiness to attend work regularly (Al-Qahtani et al., 2020).

Therefore, a low absenteeism rate can be considered a reliable manifestation of job satisfaction. It indicates that employees are motivated, comfortable within their work environment, and willing to invest effort in fulfilling their responsibilities. This relationship reinforces the idea that improving job satisfaction is not only beneficial for employee well-being, but also essential for maintaining organizational stability and reducing disruptions caused by repeated absences (Al-Anazi, 2016).

Guidelines to improve job satisfaction:

Among the means that can be used in this regard are the following:

- **Justice in wages and rewards:** When individuals believe that they are receiving unfair wages and rewards, this would create a sense of dissatisfaction for them, so the organization must be keen to build a system of wages and additional benefits, with which individuals feel fair in treatment.

Some believe that when the individual feels the fairness of the rewards and benefits, he receives and the fairness of the procedures that were applied to determine what he deserves, and when we leave him some freedom to determine what he wants in terms of the type of rewards or benefits, the individual feels satisfied with his work (Aminuddin et al., 2023).

- **Improving the quality of leadership:** When the relationship between the supervisor and individuals is good, respectful, common interests are taken into account, and there are open lines of communication between the leader and his subordinates, the satisfaction of individuals with work increases (Lander, 2009).
- **Achieving decentralization in the control of organizational power:** Decentralization means giving the right to multiple individuals to make decisions. When the decision-making authority is distributed, and individuals are allowed to participate freely in decision-making, this increases their sense of satisfaction, and this is due to their feeling or belief that they can influence the organization.
- **Assigning individuals, the work that takes most of their interests:** The more there is a strong feeling among individuals that they are doing the work that takes most of their interests, the more satisfied they are with their work, and evaluation centers established by some organizations help in achieving this. Some believe that the more an individual feels that he can satisfy his interests through his

work, the more satisfied he will be with his work (Wadhwa, 2011).

Robbins & Judge (2018) lists some of the methods or ways that organizations can follow to improve the level of job satisfaction among employees, which are:

- **Realistic Expectations:** Organizations should set achievable goals to prevent anxiety and frustration among employees.
- **Long-Term Vision:** Involving employees in the organization's future plans fosters motivation and reduces short-term pressures.
- **Effective Communication:** Promoting open and honest communication helps minimize workplace frustrations.
- **Employee Well-being:** Demonstrating genuine concern for employees' happiness and welfare enhances satisfaction.
- **Learning Opportunities:** Supporting personal and career development maintains engagement and motivation.
- **Continuous Feedback:** Providing regular, honest feedback helps employees feel recognized and guided.
- **Measuring Engagement:** Periodic surveys or questionnaires can assess employees' connection to the organization.
- **Meaningful Perks:** Practical benefits like flexible schedules often impact satisfaction more than generic perks.
- **Workplace Relationships:** Encouraging collaboration and social interaction strengthens team cohesion.
- **Clear Career Path:** Offering clear advancement opportunities signals long-term organizational commitment.
 - **Empowerment:** Granting autonomy in decision-making allows employees to take pride in their work.

Professional Performance:

Nurses' job performance is a central concern for healthcare organizations, as it directly reflects the quality of care,

patient outcomes, and the achievement of organizational objectives. Job performance can be defined as the ability of a nurse to fulfill assigned roles and responsibilities in both direct and indirect patient care (Al-Makhaita et al., 2014). It encompasses patient-related and non-patient-related nursing activities and is influenced by various factors including patients' expectations, job stress, advanced technology, quality control measures, and workload. Additional determinants of nursing performance include individual characteristics, nurse shortages, lack of resources, work experience, training, teamwork, supportive communication, leadership behavior, and organizational climate. Nurses, as the largest workforce in healthcare delivery, perform activities spanning nursing leadership, critical care, teaching/collaboration, planning and evaluation, interpersonal relations, and professional development (Samiei et al., 2016).

High levels of job performance contribute to increased productivity, improved quality of service, and enhanced patient care. Conversely, poor performance poses threats to patient safety and increases morbidity and mortality (Kahya and Oral, 2018)

Definitions of Job Performance

Job performance refers to how effectively employees fulfill their duties and responsibilities, reflecting both productivity and organizational outcomes (Nuritasari et al., 2020). It involves the use of knowledge, skills, abilities, and effort within a suitable work environment to achieve desired results (Al-Hawary & Banat, 2017).

Performance includes both in-role tasks and extra-role behaviors, and it is influenced by factors such as training, experience, leadership, feedback, and workplace conditions (Eltahir, 2018). High job performance enhances productivity, quality of service, and patient care, whereas poor performance can threaten organizational goals and safety (Evans, 2021)..

Elements of professional performance:

Professional performance consists of a group of elements, the most important of which can be explained as follows:

- **First:** Knowledge of job requirements: This includes skill, technical knowledge, and general background on the job and related fields.
- **Second:** The quality of work: It includes accuracy, order, proficiency, ingenuity, technical empowerment, the ability to organize and carry out work, and freedom from mistakes.
- **Third:** The amount of work accomplished: It is the amount of work that an individual can accomplish under normal circumstances, and the amount of this achievement.
- **Fourth:** Perseverance and Reliability: It includes seriousness and dedication to work, the ability of the individual to assume responsibility and accomplish work in the specified times, and the extent of his need for guidance and direction from supervisors, and to evaluate the results of his work (Lebsir, 2009).

However, it must be noted that these elements are not fixed, as there are researchers who believe that there are other elements that differ from them, and this is due primarily to the fact that the phenomenon of performance and its levels is one of the most complex phenomena that organizations face, due to the multiplicity of factors that affect it.

Haynes (1999) identifies three elements of job performance:

- **Employee;** And what he possesses of knowledge, skills, interests, values, attitudes and motives.
- **Job:** The requirements and challenges it presents, and the exciting and challenging job opportunities it presents that contain the feedback component as part of it.

- **Situation;** What characterizes the organizational environment, such as a climate of work, supervision, abundance of resources, administrative systems, and organizational structure.

While D'Ortenzio (2012) indicated that elements of job performance include the following:

- Preserving working hours, which is knowing the employee's commitment to working hours and not leaving his workplace without prior permission or moving between offices to exchange conversations that are not related to work.
- Being keen on matters of safety and prevention at work, which means being careful to avoid everything that leads to the possibility of material or human damage, and trying to identify the danger points in small and large matters.
- Knowledge of work systems and procedures, which means knowledge of the employee's level of knowledge of work laws, systems and procedures.

Performance Standards:

Aminuddin et al. (2023) defines performance standards as “a concise statement describing the end result that an employee is expected to achieve when performing the required work.” In this sense, the performance standard represents a clear and brief description of the anticipated outcomes associated with effective job performance. These standards function as an internal framework—or an implicit agreement—between the manager and the employee, clarifying how optimal performance can be attained.

The primary purpose of establishing performance standards is to continuously monitor employee performance in order to identify any fluctuations in performance levels and intervene promptly to address shortcomings or deficiencies. These standards also help distinguish between performance effectiveness and performance efficiency. Performance

effectiveness refers to the extent to which individuals achieve organizational objectives and fulfill required tasks. In contrast, performance efficiency pertains to the manner in which employees utilize available resources and techniques in executing tasks and contributing to the achievement of organizational goals (Almashayekh et al., 2023).

The most important performance criteria are limited to the following:

- **Quality:** Quality represents the extent to which organizational activities are carried out with precision and professionalism. Its significance has grown in contemporary institutions that depend on information and communication technologies, where the reliability and accuracy of outputs are essential for achieving high levels of service delivery (Al-Nimr et al., 2011).
- **Quantity:** Quantity relates to the total amount of work completed within available resources and in alignment with employees' skills and capabilities. Establishing clear expectations regarding workload between supervisors and employees helps promote consistent performance improvement, particularly as individuals gain experience and receive continuous professional training (Aminuddin et al., 2023).
- **Time:** Time is a vital and non-recoverable resource, making its optimal use fundamental to effective performance. Evaluating time-related performance requires agreement on suitable deadlines for task completion, taking into account the size of the workload, the number of employees involved, and the technical tools available for executing the tasks.
- **Procedures:** Procedures are structured and sequential steps adopted to ensure tasks are performed correctly and consistently. For procedures to support organizational effectiveness, they must be clearly documented, easily

understood, and accessible to all employees. While innovation should be encouraged, any proposed modifications to procedures must align with institutional regulations and be discussed with supervisors to ensure compliance and continuity (Al-Khalidi, 2018).

- **Beneficiary Satisfaction:** Beneficiary satisfaction serves as a primary indicator of the success of organizational performance. It reflects the extent to which goods or services meet expectations and contributes to enhanced productivity and increased value or profitability. It is ultimately the most accurate measure of whether performance outcomes have achieved their intended goals (Al-Nimr et al., 2011).

In conclusion, performance evaluation hinges on five key criteria: quality, quantity, time management, adherence to procedures, and beneficiary satisfaction. These dimensions collectively provide a comprehensive framework for assessing and enhancing employee effectiveness. By emphasizing these criteria, organizations can ensure optimal resource utilization, maintain high standards of service delivery, foster accountability, and achieve strategic objectives, thereby promoting sustainable organizational success and continuous improvement in all operational areas

Determinants of job performance :

Job performance is the outcome of an individual's work, efforts, and the application of their skills in fulfilling organizational roles. It can be conceptualized as the product of effort, ability, skill, and knowledge in accomplishing job tasks (Gavrea et al., 2011). According to Mansor et al. (2011), effort is influenced by encouragement and support, while abilities and skills are personal attributes that are leveraged in professional tasks within a given level of effort.

The determinants of individual performance can be classified into factors arising from internal personal resources,

such as skills, prior training experiences, organizational training, and continuous self-learning related to the job. Abu Sharkh (2010) categorizes performance determinants into three main types:

- **Declarative Knowledge:** This involves understanding facts, principles, objectives, and job requirements. It is usually assessed in written or theoretical formats.
- **Procedural Knowledge:** This refers to the practical application of knowledge in performing tasks. It combines cognitive and technical skills, physical abilities, motivation, and coordination to execute work effectively.
- **Initiative and Motivation:** This represents the interaction between decision-making regarding performance, the level of effort applied, and the persistence of that effort over time. It reflects the employee's drive to achieve and sustain high performance.

Boussbaïa and Bousaadia (2020) mention the determinants of professional performance as follows:

- **Effort:** Effort represents the physical, motor, and mental energy exerted by employees to perform their tasks. It is influenced by the support and motivation received from the organization, as well as by factors that encourage or discourage performance. These energies interact synergistically to accomplish required tasks, making effort a key determinant of both individual and collective job performance (Al-Mahasna, 2013).
- **Perception of the Role:** Role perception refers to an individual's understanding of their responsibilities, the behaviors required for their role, and how they should perform within the organization. Employees interpret directives, feedback from colleagues, rewards, and incentives through their personal motives and prior experiences. This leads to varying interpretations of the same circumstances;

for example, one employee may view rewards as recognition of competence, while another may perceive them as favoritism (Ben Rahmoun, 2014).

- **Abilities:** Abilities interact with motivation to determine performance and are influenced by the nature of the required tasks. They include:
 - **Motor Abilities:** Responses based on perception of stimuli, measured by speed, coordination, kinesthetic sense, and physical fitness.
 - **Sensory Abilities:** Critical senses such as hearing and sight, which facilitate adaptation to the work environment.
 - **Cognitive Abilities:** Mental capacities that impact performance in complex tasks, encompassing general intelligence. These can be divided into two categories: (a) linguistic, arithmetic, and educational abilities linked to formal learning, and (b) mechanical and manual abilities relevant to hands-on tasks (Ibrahim & Shawky, 2017).
- **Environmental Factors:** Performance is also affected by external conditions beyond the individual's control. Physical conditions such as lighting, noise, temperature, machine arrangement, and supervision, as well as organizational policies, design, and training, can influence performance by affecting the individual's effort, abilities, and direction (Okasha, 2008).

Factors affecting professional performance

The performance of any institution is shaped by a complex interplay of internal and external factors. These determinants influence performance indicators, whether high or low, and understanding them is crucial for establishing effective strategies to enhance organizational outcomes. Due to their diversity and interdependence, these factors are best analyzed through a structured approach, dividing them into internal and external categories.

First: Internal Factors

Internal factors originate from within the institution and are largely controllable, allowing management to amplify their positive impact and mitigate potential drawbacks. Key internal factors include:

- **Technical Factors:**
 - The nature and sophistication of technology used in operations and information processing.
 - The balance between machinery and human workforce.
 - The design, layout, and adequacy of facilities and equipment.
 - Alignment between services offered and stakeholder needs.
 - Strategic geographical positioning (Sandoog, 2017).
- **Organizational Structure:** A well-defined organizational structure clarifies specialization, division of labor, reporting hierarchies, and coordination mechanisms, all of which streamline operations and enhance efficiency.
- **Human Resources:**

The effectiveness of human capital is influenced by:

 - Workforce composition and competency.
 - Recruitment, selection, and appointment policies.
 - Training, professional development, and capacity-building initiatives.
 - Compensation, incentives, and reward systems.
 - Transparent and fair performance appraisal mechanisms

Second: External Factors:

External factors lie beyond the institution's direct control yet exert a profound influence on its performance. According to Timgadin (2013), these include:

- **Political Factors:** Political stability, policy shifts, conflicts, and regulatory restrictions can dramatically affect institutional operations.
- **Economic Factors:** Macroeconomic conditions such as inflation, interest rates, employment levels, wage trends, and

energy costs directly impact institutional sustainability and decision-making.

- **Social Factors:** Demographics, societal norms, educational levels, and consumption patterns shape both service demand and workforce dynamics.
- **Technological Factors:** Advancements in research, innovation, and communication systems drive operational efficiency and create competitive advantages.
- **Environmental and Legislative Factors:** Labor laws, environmental regulations, and consumer protection statutes define institutional responsibilities and compliance requirements, ensuring ethical and legal accountability

Beyond structural and environmental factors, several key elements directly influence professional performance (Sandoog, 2017):

- Lack of clearly defined goals and operational plans undermines direction and efficiency.
- Limited employee participation reduces accountability and motivation.
- Variability in individual performance can affect overall institutional outcomes.
- Linking performance to tangible and intangible rewards enhances commitment and output.
- Job satisfaction remains a decisive factor in sustaining high performance.

The complexity of these factors is compounded by their interdependence. Al-Rebaq (2004) emphasizes that leadership traits, organizational objectives, resource availability, employee needs, and community expectations interact in ways that make isolating single determinants challenging. Consequently, effective performance management requires a holistic and dynamic approach, integrating both controllable internal factors and uncontrollable external influences.

Commentary on the theoretical framework

The reviewed literature highlights that job satisfaction and professional performance are central pillars in maintaining the stability and effectiveness of healthcare systems, particularly within high-pressure units such as Eds and ICUs. The synthesis clearly demonstrates that job satisfaction extends beyond emotional well-being; it directly shapes nurses' levels of commitment, organizational loyalty, productivity, and adherence to professional standards. Prior studies consistently indicate that job satisfaction is influenced by a complex interplay of internal and external factors, including supervision quality, communication patterns, salary fairness, peer relationships, promotion opportunities, and the overall work environment. In turn, professional performance emerges as an outcome of these determinants, where highly satisfied nurses exhibit enhanced clinical competence, better responsiveness to patient needs, and stronger compliance with safety protocols.

The significance of these dimensions becomes even more pronounced in crisis settings, where nurses face extraordinary psychological, physical, and operational burdens that heighten the risk of burnout and turnover. Consequently, the literature emphasizes the necessity for healthcare institutions to adopt targeted strategies that foster job satisfaction, such as improving leadership practices, ensuring equitable compensation, enhancing working conditions, and offering continuous professional development. Investing in job satisfaction is therefore not merely an administrative concern; it is a strategic imperative that strengthens patient safety, improves the quality of care, and supports the long-term sustainability of the nursing workforce. Understanding and reinforcing this relationship is essential for achieving resilient and efficient healthcare delivery at both the individual and organizational levels.

Methodology

Study design

This study utilized descriptive, analytical, cross-sectional design.

Setting of the study

This study was conducted in major governmental hospitals in the Gaza Strip. The researcher purposively selected one major hospital from each governorate. The selected hospitals were: European Gaza Hospital, Nasser Medical Complex, Al-Aqsa Martyrs Hospital, Al-Shifa Medical Complex, and the Indonesian Hospital.

Study population

The target population of this study consisted of all nurses working in the Emergency Departments (ER) and Intensive Care Units (ICU) of governmental hospitals who had at least six months of continuous experience. This criterion was applied to ensure that participants possess sufficient clinical exposure and familiarity with the work environment, thereby enhancing the accuracy of population representation and minimizing potential sampling errors.

The final sample included 180 nurses from ERs and 113 nurses from ICUs. The researcher distributed questionnaires to all eligible participants to obtain comprehensive and diverse responses that support robust and reliable data analysis.

Sample and Sampling

The sample of this study is a census sample, therefore, all nurses who are working in the EDs and ICU at Shifa Medical Complex, EGH, Nasser Medical Complex, Al-Aqsa Martyrs Hospital, and Indonesian Hospital were included in the study. The total number of them is 293 nurses (MoH, 2022), Table 1 clarify distribution nurses according Hospital and departments.

Table 1: Distribution nurses according Hospital and Departments

Hospital Name	ER	ICU	Total
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Shifa Medical Complex	61	31	92
European Gaza Hospital	22	32	54
Nasser Medical Complex	34	18	52
Al-Aqsa Martyrs Hospital	33	12	45
Indonesian Hospital	30	20	50
Total	180	113	293

3.6 Eligibility Criteria

3.6.1 Inclusion Criteria

- Nurses working in adult EDs and ICUs at the governmental hospitals.
- Not in a long-term vacation.
- Interested to participate.
- At least six-month experience.
- Fixed term contract.

3.6.2 Exclusion criteria:

- Trained nurses who did not consented to participate in the study.
- All nurses who were not at work place during data collection period like those on leave.
- Nurses with less than six month of work experience.

3.8 Study Tools

A structured questionnaire was developed by the researcher after reviewing relevant previous studies.

The questionnaire included multiple questions. The variety of these questions is designed first to meet up with the research objectives, also to gather all the required data that can support the conversation, results and advice in the study. The questionnaire made up of four sections to perform the purpose of the research. The following is a detailed description of the questionnaire content:

The first part is sociodemographic data of the respondent (gender, age, place of residence, marital status, qualification, years of experience, family size, monthly income, etc.).

The Second part is job satisfaction, include (44) paragraphs divided into Six dimensions as following:

1. Working conditions.
2. Promotions.
3. Contingent and Reward
4. Supervising and communication.
5. Co-work.
6. Working Procedure.

The Third part: It is a measure of the professional performance of nurses, and it consists of 31 items distributed over four domains, and each domain consists of a group of items, and the domains are:

- **First domain:** Quality of professional performance, and it consists of 10 paragraphs.
- **Second domain:** Quantity of professional performance, and it consists of 9 paragraphs.
- **Third domain:** Speed of professional performance, and it consists of 6 paragraphs.
- **Fourth domain:** Creativity in professional performance, and it consists of 6 paragraphs.

3.9 Reliability of study instruments

The questionnaire reliability was measured by applying Cronbach's Alpha test on the questionnaire dimensions. This test is used to measure the reliability of the questionnaire dimensions and the mean of the whole dimensions of the questionnaire. The value of Cronbach's Alpha coefficient lies between (0-1), the higher the value of Cronbach's Alpha coefficient the higher the reliability of the measured items. The resultant value of Cronbach's Alpha coefficient of each dimension is as shown in table 2. The value of Cronbach's Alpha coefficient 0.827, which is considered relatively high values reflecting high reliability of questionnaire paragraphs. This indicates excellent reliability value for the entire questionnaire.

Table 2: Cronbach's Alpha for each dimension of the questionnaire and the entire field

No.	Dimension	Cronbach's Alpha
	Job satisfaction	0.811
1.	Working conditions	0.798
2.	Promotions	0.801
3.	Contingent and Reward	0.735
4.	Supervising and communication	0.742
5.	Co-work	0.821
6.	Working Procedure	0.837
	Professional performance	0.834
1.	Quality of professional performance	0.831
2.	Quantity of professional performance	0.847
3.	Speed of professional performance	0.741
4.	Creativity in professional performance	0.753
	All items	0.827

Validity of study instruments

Face Validity

To increase the response rate, it is important to maintain good face validity for the questionnaire. The researcher constructed the questionnaire in an appealing design. And researcher asked the participants in the pilot study about their opinions regarding the structure, shape, clarity and format

Content Validity

The questionnaire was evaluated by experts to validate the questions and their relation to the domains that reflect the study and their comments were taken into consideration and modification was performed accordingly. Many useful and important modifications and comments were made and taken into consideration for the questionnaire.

Statistical Validity

To ensure the validity of the questionnaire, two statistical tests should be applied. The first test is internal validity (Pearson test) which measure the correlation coefficient between each item in the dimension and the whole dimension. The second test is structure validity (Pearson test) that used to test the validity of the questionnaire structure by testing the validity of each dimension and the validity of the whole questionnaire. It measures the correlation coefficient between one dimension and all the dimensions of the questionnaire that have the same level of similar scale.

Internal Validity

The internal consistency was measured by calculating the value of the correlation coefficient the paragraph and the total degree of the dimension to which this paragraph belongs.

First: Validity of the internal consistency of the Job Satisfaction:

Results in annex 8 showed that the probability value of each paragraph of the dimension is less than the level of significance 0.05, and this confirms the statistical relationship between the paragraph and the total score of the dimension, and this means that these paragraphs have measured the goal for which they were set.

Second: Validity of the internal consistency of the dimension (Professional Performance)

Results in annex 8 showed that the probability value of each paragraph of the dimension is less than the level of significance 0.05, and this confirms the statistical relationship between the paragraph and the total score of the dimension, and this means that these paragraphs have measured the goal for which they were set.



Structure Validity

Structure validity is the second statistical test that used to test the validity of the questionnaire structure by testing the validity of each dimension and the validity of the whole questionnaire. It measures the correlation coefficient between one dimension and all the dimensions of the questionnaire that have the same level of liker scale.

the significance values are less than 0.05, so the correlation coefficients of all the dimensions are significant at $\alpha = 0.05$, so it can be said that the dimensions are valid to be measured what it was set for to achieve the main aim of the study.

Pilot Study

The researcher selected 30 nurses from the study population who met the inclusion criteria to participate in a pilot study. The purpose of the pilot was to assess the clarity and usability of the instrument, identify any ambiguous items, and estimate the time required to complete the questionnaire. Since no major modifications were needed following the pilot results, these participants were retained and included in the final data analysis.

Data Collection

The researcher collected data by himself using a self-administered questionnaire after obtaining the consent from the study participants from the above-mentioned hospitals within a duration of two month. The average time for filling the questionnaire about 15 minutes. The covering letter of the questionnaires outline the title and the purpose of the study and the identity of the researcher.

Response Rate

The total number of questionnaires distributed to the target population was 293 questionnaires. Of them, 280 questionnaires were completed and returned to the researcher

with a response rate of 95.6%. These response rates are considered satisfactory.

Data Management

Data Entry:

The collected data entered into the computer software "Statistical Package for Social Sciences" SPSS program by the researcher after coding of the questions and then cleaning of the entered data.

Data Analysis:

The researcher analysed the collected data by using the SPSS software program. Different statistical tests were used in the analysis including central of tendency; mean, mode, average, rate, percentage, frequency distribution for all variables of the questionnaires one-way ANOVA, t-test, spearman test, ...etc. Differences were considered significant at a p value of ≤ 0.05 .

Statistical Analysis Procedures

The following statistical techniques were used:

- Frequencies and Relative frequency
- Measures of central tendency (mean), and measurement of dispersion (standard deviation).
- Weighted mean
- Independent sample t test: To investigate if there is a statistically significant mean difference between two groups due to the study variables, such as (gender).

One-way ANOVA test: To investigate if there is a statistically significant mean difference between more than two groups due to the study variables, such as (age category, income, educational level..., etc)

Results and Discussion:

The socio-demographic analysis (Table 3) reveals that the majority of participating nurses were male (67.5%), which indicates a male-dominant nursing workforce in the studied

governmental hospitals contrary to the traditionally female-dominated nature of nursing in many regions. Most participants (55%) were relatively young, aged between 20 and 30 years, reflecting a predominantly early-career nursing population that could be both adaptive to innovation and vulnerable to occupational stress due to limited experience.

Married nurses constituted 61.1% of the sample, suggesting potential family-related responsibilities that may influence work-life balance and job satisfaction. In terms of education, a substantial proportion (76.1%) held a bachelor's degree, indicating a generally well-qualified nursing workforce, while only a small fraction (6.8%) had postgraduate education, reflecting limited opportunities for advanced professional development.

The distribution across departments showed a slightly higher representation from emergency departments (60.7%) compared to intensive care units (39.3%), both of which are high-stress environments that demand rapid decision-making and resilience. The majority of participants reported moderate-sized families (four to six members), which may impact economic and psychological stability.

Economically, most nurses (86.8%) earned less than 2000 NIS monthly, highlighting a significant income constraint that could contribute to dissatisfaction and turnover. Regarding professional experience, more than 60% had less than five years of experience, suggesting a relatively young and possibly transitional workforce still building clinical and organizational competence.

Overall, these findings portray a predominantly young, moderately educated, and economically constrained nursing population operating under demanding clinical conditions factors that collectively may shape their job satisfaction, stress levels, and professional performance.

Table 3: Socio-demographic characteristics of participants

Variable	Categories	Frequency (F)	Percent (%)
Gender	Male	189	67.5
	Female	91	32.5
Age	20 to less than 30	154	55.0
	30 to less than 40	121	43.2
	More than 40	5	1.8
Marital status	Not married	109	38.9
	Married	171	61.1
Education Level	2 years Diploma	48	17.1
	Bachelor	213	76.1
	Postgraduate	19	6.8
Department	EDs	170	60.7
	ICU	110	39.3
Total family members	1 to 3	84	30.0
	4 to 6	140	50.0
	7 to 9	48	17.1
	More than 10	8	2.9
Monthly income (NIS)	1000 to less than 2000	243	86.8
	2000 to less than 3000	33	11.8
	3000 to 4000	4	1.4
Experience in the department (Years)	1 to less than 5	173	61.8
	5 to less than 10	83	29.6
	More than 10 years	24	8.6

To evaluate the level of job satisfaction among Palestinian nurses employed in governmental hospitals across the southern governorates of Palestine, table 4 presents the mean, standard deviations, relative weights, test statistics, and corresponding probability values (P-values) for the various dimensions of job satisfaction.

Table 4: Level of job satisfaction of Palestinians nurses

Dimensions	Mean	SD	RII (%)	T.V	P-value	Ranked
Working conditions	2.76	0.44	55.11	-9.21	0.001	5
Promotions	2.67	0.38	53.46	-14.58	0.001	6
Contingent and Reward	3.05	0.50	61.05	1.75	0.081	3
Supervising and communication	2.89	0.36	57.84	-5.02	0.001	4
Co-work	3.88	0.49	77.55	33.36	0.001	1
Working Procedure	3.35	0.46	67.08	12.96	0.001	2
Total	3.34	0.63	66.77	10.06	0.001	

SD= Standrar deviation **T.V=** Test value

The results presented in table 4 reveal a moderate level of job satisfaction among nurses working in governmental hospitals in the southern governorates of Palestine (mean = 3.34; RII = 66.77%). This indicates that although nurses maintain a reasonable degree of contentment, substantial organizational and structural gaps continue to affect their overall workplace experience. The highest-rated dimension—"co-worker relationships" (mean = 3.88; RII = 77.55%)—highlights the strong sense of solidarity and mutual support among nursing staff, a vital factor for sustaining morale within highly stressful environments. Additionally, the dimension of "working procedures" (mean = 3.35; RII = 67.08%) suggests that institutional guidelines and workflow clarity positively influence the efficiency and daily functioning of nurses. Conversely, the lowest-rated dimensions—"promotion opportunities" (mean = 2.67; RII = 53.46%) and "working conditions" (mean = 2.76; RII = 55.11%)—reflect deep dissatisfaction with career advancement pathways, recognition mechanisms, and the physical and administrative work environment. The statistically significant

differences ($P = 0.001$) across most dimensions underscore the severity of these barriers and their implications for workforce motivation, retention, and professional stability.

These outcomes must be interpreted within the broader socio-political and economic context of Gaza, where ongoing conflict, recurrent Israeli military aggression, and prolonged public health crises—most notably COVID-19—have amplified occupational stress. Reduced government salaries (60% payment) and chronic resource shortages further exacerbate dissatisfaction. Comparable studies support this interpretation: Said and El-Shafei (2020) reported similarly low satisfaction among Egyptian nurses, while Senek et al. (2020) found widespread dissatisfaction in the UK even prior to the pandemic. In contrast, Yu et al. (2020) documented relatively higher satisfaction among frontline staff in China, pointing to the importance of institutional preparedness and support systems. Evidence from Labrague and Santos (2020) shows that pandemic-related fear significantly reduced job satisfaction and increased turnover intention, further emphasizing the psychological pressures on nurses. Studies from Indonesia (Hidayat & Agustina, 2021) and Tanzania (Leshabari et al., 2008) reaffirm that positive work environments, supportive leadership, and effective reward structures strongly enhance satisfaction—consistent with the present study's finding that coworker support remains a major protective factor. Likewise, Singh (2017) demonstrated that nurses in private hospitals reported higher satisfaction than their counterparts in public institutions in India, underscoring the influence of organizational culture and resource availability.

Overall, the results align with global evidence showing that while interpersonal relationships constitute a core strength within nursing teams, improving working conditions, career pathways, managerial communication, and institutional support

is critical for enhancing job satisfaction and sustaining high-quality nursing services in challenging contexts such as Gaza

To assess the level of performance of Palestinians nurses working at governmental hospitals at southern governorates of Palestine, table (5) appears mean, standard deviation, relative weight, test value, and probability value (P-value) were extracted.

Table 5: Level of professional performance of Palestinians nurses

Dimensions	Mean	SD	RII (%)	T.V	P-value	Ranked
Quality of professional performance	3.97	0.44	79.30	36.34	0.001	1
Quantity of professional performance	3.63	0.46	72.53	22.73	0.001	4
Speed of professional performance	3.80	0.56	76.08	23.89	0.001	3
Creativity in professional performance	3.94	0.54	78.71	29.25	0.001	2
Total	3.83	0.40	76.60	34.92	0.001	
SD= Standrar deviation			T.V= Test value			

The results presented in table 5 clearly demonstrate that Palestinian nurses working in governmental hospitals in the southern governorates exhibit a high overall level of professional performance (mean = 3.83; RII = 76.60%). This strong performance—despite the moderate levels of job satisfaction reported earlier—reflects a remarkable sense of professional responsibility, ethical commitment, and resilience within a highly challenging healthcare environment. The highest-scoring dimensions, such as “quality of professional performance” and “creativity in performance,” suggest that nurses consistently uphold accuracy, patient safety, and innovative problem-solving,

even under conditions of resource shortages, heavy workload, and recurring emergencies. The satisfactory ratings in speed and quantity of performance further indicate that nurses are capable of managing demanding clinical duties efficiently while maintaining acceptable standards of care.

These findings align closely with international evidence demonstrating that nurses often sustain high performance due to intrinsic motivation and professional ethics rather than favorable working conditions. Studies in Saudi Arabia (Al-Makhaita et al., 2014) and Jordan (Abualrub & Al-Zaru, 2008) similarly reported elevated performance levels among nurses working under stressful environments, highlighting the influence of professionalism and duty. However, the literature also warns that prolonged dissatisfaction—particularly related to supervision, promotion, and work conditions—can gradually erode performance, as noted by Al-Hamdan et al. (2017), Lu et al. (2019), and Tarcan et al. (2017). This underscores the need for administrative interventions to sustain current performance levels.

The correlation analysis reinforces this conclusion: the strong positive relationship between job satisfaction and professional performance ($r = 0.728$, $p = 0.001$) indicates that improvements in satisfaction—particularly regarding supervision, communication, and career development—are likely to result in significant gains in performance quality, efficiency, and creativity. This finding aligns with organizational behavior theory, which asserts that employees who feel valued, supported, and fairly rewarded demonstrate higher productivity and commitment (Locke, 1976; Judge et al., 2001).

Table 6: Correlation coefficient between job satisfaction and professional performance

Professional performance	
Job satisfaction	R = 0.728
	P-value= 0.001
R= Correlation coefficient	

In summary, while Palestinian nurses demonstrate exceptional professional performance despite challenging conditions, maintaining and enhancing this performance will require strategic investment in job satisfaction factors. Supportive leadership, fair promotion systems, and improved working conditions are essential to preserving nurses' resilience and ensuring sustainable, high-quality healthcare delivery.

The results presented in table 5 indicate that most socio-demographic variables—including gender, age, marital status, educational level, department, and workplace—do not exhibit statistically significant differences in job satisfaction among Palestinian nurses working in governmental hospitals ($p > 0.05$). This suggests a relative homogeneity in professional satisfaction across demographic groups, implying that organizational and work-related factors, such as workload, management style, and working conditions, play a more decisive role in shaping job satisfaction than individual characteristics.

The absence of gender differences ($p = 0.573$) aligns with the findings of Lu et al. (2019) and Hayes et al. (2010), who emphasized that nurses' satisfaction is influenced more by leadership support and organizational climate than by gender or marital status. Similarly, educational level was not significantly associated with job satisfaction ($p = 0.746$), consistent with Al-Makhaita et al. (2014), who reported that professional satisfaction is determined primarily by career development opportunities and equitable compensation rather than academic qualifications.

Although age did not reach statistical significance ($p = 0.077$), nurses aged 40–50 reported slightly higher satisfaction ($M = 3.28$), suggesting that professional experience enhances coping strategies and job stability. This observation is in line with Yau et al. (2012), who noted that resilience and professional maturity improve satisfaction in demanding healthcare environments.

Importantly, two variables—monthly income ($p = 0.018$) and departmental experience ($p = 0.013$)—demonstrated significant effects on job satisfaction. Nurses with higher income levels reported greater satisfaction, echoing the findings of Abualrub and Al-Zaru (2008), who highlighted that financial rewards and recognition significantly boost motivation and retention. This underscores the critical role of adequate compensation in maintaining morale and reducing turnover, particularly in high-demand healthcare settings.

Similarly, departmental experience had a significant impact, with nurses holding moderate tenure (5–10 years) reporting higher satisfaction, likely due to increased confidence, skill proficiency, and social integration within their teams. However, satisfaction tends to decline with extended tenure, possibly reflecting work fatigue or limited career advancement opportunities—a trend also noted by Tarcan et al. (2017) regarding burnout and job satisfaction among healthcare staff.

Geographical and institutional factors, such as place of residence or hospital of employment, were not significantly associated with satisfaction, indicating that working conditions are relatively uniform across governmental hospitals in the southern governorates. This suggests that systemic challenges, rather than local or institutional differences, are the primary determinants of job satisfaction.

In conclusion, these findings emphasize that organizational and economic factors—particularly income and

departmental experience—are the strongest predictors of job satisfaction among Palestinian nurses. Enhancing financial incentives, providing structured professional development, and encouraging mobility within departments are therefore essential strategies to improve satisfaction and retention, ultimately contributing to higher-quality patient care

Table 7: Relationship between socio-demographic variables and job satisfaction

Variable	Class	Mean	STD	Test statistic	P-value
Gender	Male	3.05	0.253	T= 0.564	0.573
	Female	3.07	0.227		
Education Level	2 years Diploma	3.05	0.190	F=0.293	0.746
	Bachelor	3.06	0.259		
	Postgraduate	3.09	0.195		
Age	20 to less than 30	3.04	0.268	F=2.590	0.077
	30 to less than 40	3.07	0.211		
	40 to 50	3.28	0.065		
Marital status	Not married	3.04	0.275	T= 1.137	0.256
	Married	3.07	0.223		
Department	EDs	3.05	0.232	T= 1.136	0.257
	ICU	3.08	0.263		
Total family members	1-3	3.03	0.277	F=1.204	0.309
	4-6	3.05	0.246		
	7-9	3.10	0.171		
	10+	3.15	0.191		
Place of Residence	North Gaza	3.05	0.212	F=2.066	0.085
	Gaza city	3.04	0.269		
	Mid-Zone	3.10	0.242		
	Khan Younis	2.98	0.331		

	Rafah	3.09	0.196		
	Indonesian Hospital	3.07	0.19		
	Nasser Medical Complex	3.05	0.31		
Place of work (Hospital)	Shifa Medical Complex	3.05	0.27	F=0.155	0.961
	Al-Aqsa Hospital	3.05	0.20		
	European Gaza Hospital	3.08	0.21		
	1000 to less than 2000	3.05	0.24		
Monthly income (NIS)	2000 to less than 3000	3.14	0.19	F=4.079	0.018*
	3000 to 4000	2.83	0.50		
	1 to less than 5	3.05	0.23		
Total Experience in the nursing	5 to less than 10	3.07	0.27	F=0.041	0.989
	10 to less than 15	3.06	0.23		
	15-20	3.06	0.25		
	1 to less than 5	3.07	0.22		
Experience in the department	5 to less than 10	3.08	0.26	F=4.386	0.013*
	10 -16	2.92	0.30		

*** Differences is significant at 0.05**

The linear regression analysis presented in Table 8 reveals a strong and statistically significant relationship between job satisfaction and professional performance among Palestinian

nurses working in governmental hospitals ($\beta = 0.574$, $t = 12.21$, $p = 0.000$). The model accounts for 64.2% of the variance in performance levels ($R^2 = 0.642$), indicating that job satisfaction is a powerful predictor of nursing performance. This finding suggests that as nurses' satisfaction with their work environment, supervision, and opportunities for professional growth increases, their capacity to perform effectively, creatively, and efficiently is substantially enhanced.

These results are consistent with prior research emphasizing the pivotal role of job satisfaction in healthcare performance. Lu et al. (2019) demonstrated that higher job satisfaction significantly boosts nurses' commitment, efficiency, and the overall quality of care. Similarly, Abualrub and Al-Zaru (2008) found that satisfaction with recognition and equitable compensation directly improves performance and reduces turnover intentions among nurses in Jordan. The strong positive beta coefficient in the current study reinforces the theoretical premise that satisfied nurses exhibit higher intrinsic motivation and professional engagement, even under demanding working conditions.

Moreover, the significant F-value ($F = 98.251$, $p = 0.000$) underscores the robustness of the regression model, confirming that the predictive power of job satisfaction on professional performance is not attributable to random variation. This statistical strength aligns with Hayes et al. (2010), who highlighted that job satisfaction influences multiple dimensions of performance, including teamwork, accuracy, and patient-centered care.

However, studies such as Tarcan et al. (2017) caution that prolonged dissatisfaction, burnout, and suboptimal working conditions can gradually erode performance. While the current study reflects generally high levels of satisfaction and performance, it signals a potential risk if organizational

challenges—such as excessive workload, limited promotion opportunities, and financial constraints—remain unaddressed. The alignment of these findings with both regional and international research emphasizes the universal link between psychological well-being in the workplace and professional productivity in nursing.

Table 8: Linear Regression Results – Performance

	B	Std. Error	t	P-value
C	1.293	0.188	6.87	0.000*
Job satisfaction	0.574	0.047	12.21	0.000*
F= 98.251 Sig=0.000 R²=64.2%				

In conclusion, the regression results underscore the critical role of job satisfaction as a key determinant of nursing performance. To sustain and further enhance performance outcomes, hospital administrators and policymakers should prioritize strengthening the organizational climate, particularly through improved communication, reward systems, and structured career development pathways. Such interventions not only elevate job satisfaction but also promote safer, higher-quality patient care and greater institutional efficiency.

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